WonderFleet — keys and domains

Google Maps Platform · Twilio SMS · DNS for wonderfleet.org
Ofemini Global Limited · prepared 21 October 2026

Everything in this guide is optional except the DNS records. WonderFleet runs without a Google key and without Twilio: weather falls back to a free service, route planning falls back to a built-in calculation, and SMS alerts are written to the server log instead of being sent. Add each one when you want that feature live.

1. Google Maps Platform

What WonderFleet uses it for

Four APIs, each behind a specific feature. If you only want some of those features, enable only those APIs — anything not enabled simply falls back.

API to enable	What stops working without it
Geocoding API	Turning a typed pickup or delivery address into map coordinates. Without it you must enter coordinates by hand.
Places API (New)	Address autocomplete while adding a shipment. Without it the address box is plain typing.
Routes API	Real road distance, travel time and live traffic. Fuel estimates and planned distance fall back to a straight-line approximation.
Weather API	Temperature forecast along the route, which Route AI uses to pick a cooler departure time. Falls back to Open-Meteo, which is free and needs no key but is less detailed.

> **Billing must be enabled, even to stay free**
> Google requires a card on the account before these APIs will return anything. Each API then includes **10,000 free calls per month**, which is far more than a pilot fleet uses — a shipment costs roughly three calls. You are only charged beyond that, and step 7 sets a cap so you cannot be surprised.

Step by step

1. Open the Cloud console. Go to `console.cloud.google.com` and sign in with the Google account that should own the billing — ideally the company account, not a personal one.

2. Create a project. Click the project dropdown in the top bar, then **New project**. Name it `WonderFleet` and click **Create**. Wait for it to finish, then make sure that project is the one selected in the dropdown.

3. Turn on billing. In the left menu choose **Billing**, then **Link a billing account**, and add a card. Nigerian cards are accepted; Google places a small temporary authorisation to verify it.

4. Enable the four APIs. Go to **APIs & Services → Library**. Search for each name below, click it, then click **Enable**. Return to the Library between each one.

- Geocoding API
- Places API (New) — the one ending in “(New)”, not the older “Places API”
- Routes API
- Weather API

5. Create the key. Go to **APIs & Services → Credentials**, click **Create credentials**, then **API key**. Copy the key that appears — it starts with `AIza`.

6. Restrict the key. This matters: an unrestricted key found in a log or a screenshot can be used by anyone at your expense. Click **Edit API key**, then under **API restrictions** choose **Restrict key** and tick exactly the four APIs above. Save.

> **Leave “Application restrictions” set to None**
> That section restricts by website or IP address. WonderFleet calls Google from its server on Render, which uses a pool of shared addresses rather than one fixed address, so an IP restriction would break unpredictably. The API restriction above is the protection that actually works here.

7. Set a spending cap. Go to **Billing → Budgets & alerts → Create budget**. Set a monthly amount you are comfortable with — around $10 is plenty — and tick the alert thresholds. You will be emailed long before anything unexpected is charged.

8. Put it into Render. Open the `wonderfleet-api` service → **Environment**, and set:

`Google__ApiKey`	the key beginning `AIza`

Save. Render restarts the API automatically, and address autocomplete and route planning start working within about a minute.

2. Twilio (SMS alerts)

WonderFleet sends an SMS when cargo goes outside its temperature or humidity limits, and when a device stops reporting. Email works independently, so you can run on email alone and add SMS later.

> **Read this before buying a Twilio phone number**
> Nigerian networks do not deliver SMS sent from Twilio phone numbers. Long codes, short codes and plain numeric senders are all unsupported or best-effort only, so messages to MTN, Airtel, Glo and 9mobile will silently fail. The supported route is a **pre-registered alphanumeric sender ID** — the word *WonderFleet* appearing in place of a number. Registration takes roughly **three weeks**, so start it early. A phone number is still fine for recipients outside Nigeria.

Step by step

1. Create the account. Go to `twilio.com` and sign up. Verify your email and your own mobile number.

2. Copy the account credentials. On the console home page, the **Account Info** panel shows **Account SID** (starts with `AC`) and **Auth Token** (hidden until you click to reveal). Treat the auth token like a password — anyone holding it can send messages billed to you.

3. Register your sender ID. In the console go to **Messaging → Sender IDs → Alphanumeric Sender IDs** and start a registration for Nigeria, with `WonderFleet` as the ID. Twilio asks for company documents — your CAC certificate and a letter on company letterhead stating what the messages are for. Submit and wait; it is usually about three weeks.

Avoid generic IDs such as *Info*, *Verify* or *Notify* — Nigerian operators reject them.

4. Leave the trial. A trial account can only send to numbers you have verified, and prefixes every message with a trial notice. Add funds to upgrade before using it for real alerts.

5. Put the values into Render. Open `wonderfleet-api` → **Environment**:

Key	Value
`Sms__Twilio__AccountSid`	starts with `AC`
`Sms__Twilio__AuthToken`	the revealed token
`Sms__Twilio__FromNumber`	`WonderFleet` once the sender ID is approved — or a Twilio number in full international form for non-Nigerian recipients
`Sms__Twilio__MessagingServiceSid`	leave blank unless you use a Messaging Service, in which case fill this instead of the row above

Despite its name, `FromNumber` accepts an alphanumeric sender ID — it is passed to Twilio exactly as typed.

> **Checking it works**
> Raise a test alert by setting a device's temperature limit below its current reading on the Devices page. The Render log shows the outcome, and Twilio's **Monitor → Logs → Messaging** page shows each message with its delivery status and, if it failed, the reason.

3. DNS for wonderfleet.org

Two records at whoever you bought the domain from. Render shows the exact values to use under each service's **Settings → Custom Domains** once the blueprint has been created, and those values take priority over the examples here.

Host	Type	Points to	Serves
`@` (root)	A	the IP Render shows	the admin app at wonderfleet.org
`api`	CNAME	`wonderfleet-api.onrender.com`	the API at api.wonderfleet.org

Some registrars cannot point a root domain at an A record, or offer “ALIAS”/“ANAME” instead — use that if it is offered. Certificates are issued automatically once the records resolve, usually within an hour, occasionally up to a day.

> **Why both names are already in the configuration**
> The browser refuses to call an API on a different hostname unless that API names the site as allowed. The blueprint lists wonderfleet.org, www.wonderfleet.org and the temporary onrender.com address, so the app keeps working while DNS propagates and after it finishes.

4. What to do first

1. **Start the Twilio sender ID registration.** It is the only item with a three-week wait.
2. **Add the DNS records** so certificates are issued while you work on the rest.
3. **Create the Google key** — about fifteen minutes, and immediately improves address entry and route accuracy.
4. **Add the Twilio credentials** when the sender ID is approved.